Chapter 3

A Woman First Found Fire

SUMMARY. The first person to find fire was a woman. She sat by the fire and fed her children cooked food, while her husband slept in the dark and ate raw food. After waiting a long time, the husband stole the fire and ran off, and since then fire has been known throughout the world. It was a woman who first found fire because "a woman naturally is a great thing."

SPEAKER. *|Asa N!a'an*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

TRANSCRIBED BY. *Hacky Kgami Gcao, |Ai!ae Fridrik |Kunta, G‡kao Martin |Kaece*

jua kxaice ho da'a
the first person to find fire
o dshau
was a woman
dshaua hin tsi kxaina ho da'a
that woman who first found fire
a tsa'a
you hear
mi ǂxae
my daughter
ha hin tsi kxaice ho da'a
this person first found fire
te tcihinto'a a txun goaq n‖ae !oa kxuia a
that is what your grandmother long ago told you

ǁ'akaa ha tse ǁae ha
then she went on and kept her
ǁae ha mhsi te si!a ku 'ma ya da'a
kept her children and they all ate at the fire
te ha !'hoan ku tzaa g|u n!ang
but her husband slept in the dark
koara da'a te
had no fire and
koara da'a te tse ku tzaa g|u n!ang
had no fire and then slept in the dark
te si!a hin ku n|oaq tcisi ka ku 'm
but they cooked food and ate
ka ha ku 'm tcisi tzanasi
while he ate raw food
aia, iin
yes, mother
ǁ'akaa ha tse goaq !hai-!hai-!hai-!hai ha te
then he long ago wait, wait, wait, waited for her and he
tse ho yaa da'a ko ha dshau khoea
then got fire from his wife
te ha dshau |xoa n!ang da'a te
then his wife started the fire and
ha tse dcaa hi
he came and stole it
ǁ'a ha te ǁae hi te !aah u te hi hin ha ka g|ae tseela
so he took it and ran off and this is the fire he went and took from her
g|ae ka g|ae |xoa ǁ'akoa
(he) arrived and made fire there
dshau hin kxaice ho da'a
that woman first found fire
khama dshau n|a ǁxoasi a hin ho ka ha o tci n!a'an
because a woman naturally you see is a big thing
iin
yes
mi ǂxae
my daughter
khuin |'ae
that's how it was
ka koe te
it was like that and
ǁ'akaa ju ka cuuuu te ka kxae da'a te ku, ku, ku |xoa da'a
therefore people have continued to have fire and to, to, to make fire

ee, aie
yes, mother
khuin ⌊'ae ka oo khuian
it was like this
aie
mother
te toan
it's finished